

FIT5196 DATA WRANGLING

Week 2

Data Discovery and Collection

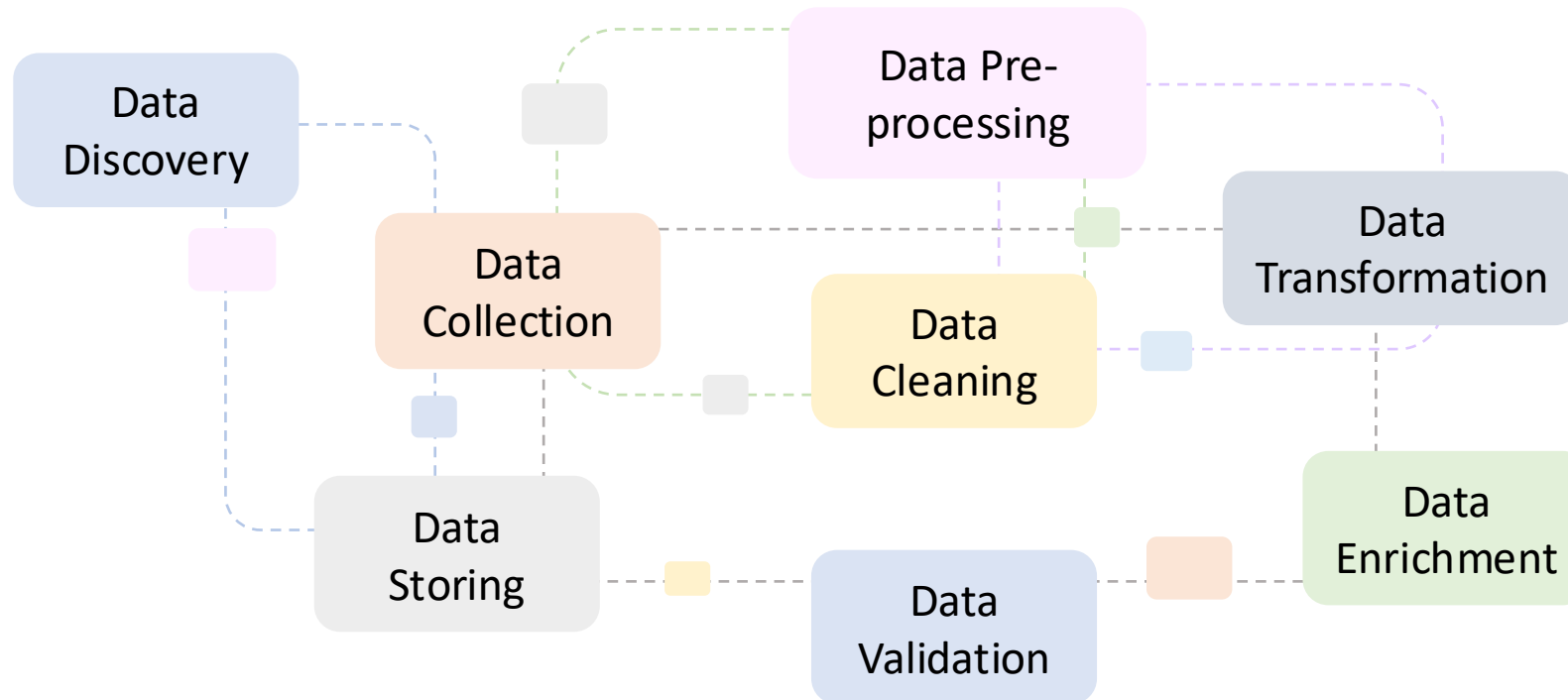
By Jackie Rong

Faculty of Information Technology

Monash University

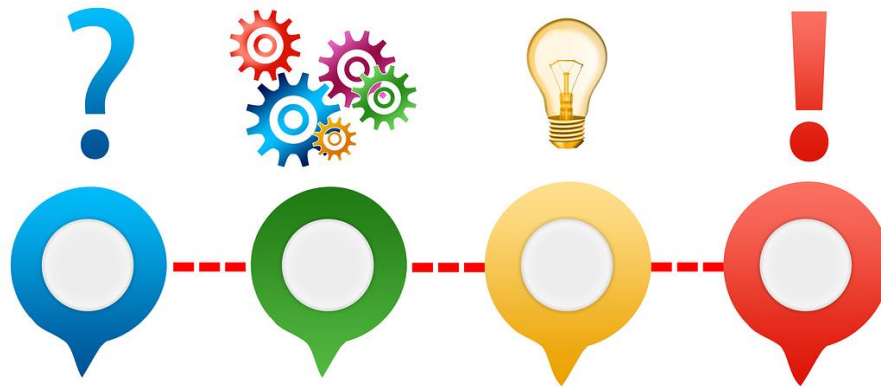
Data Wrangling Tasks (Recap)

In the **Data Wrangling** stage, preliminary data **preparation** tasks are performed to make raw data more suitable for analysis.



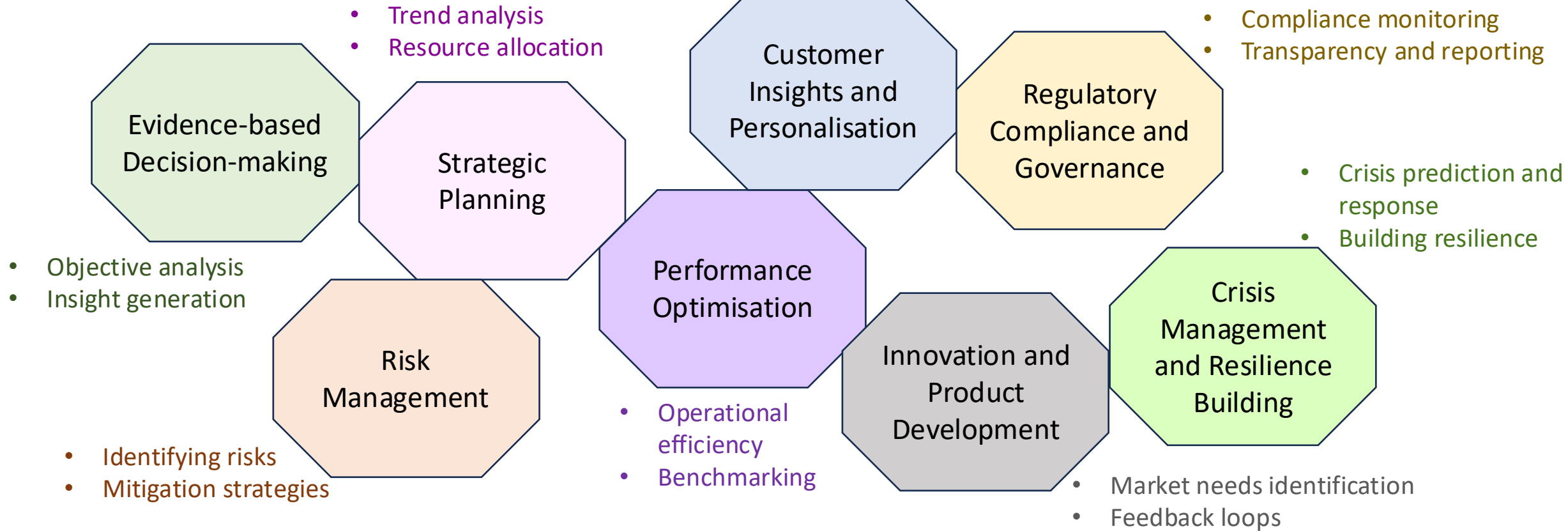
Outline

- What is Data Discovery?
- Data Discovery Process
- What is Data Collection?
- Data Collection Methods



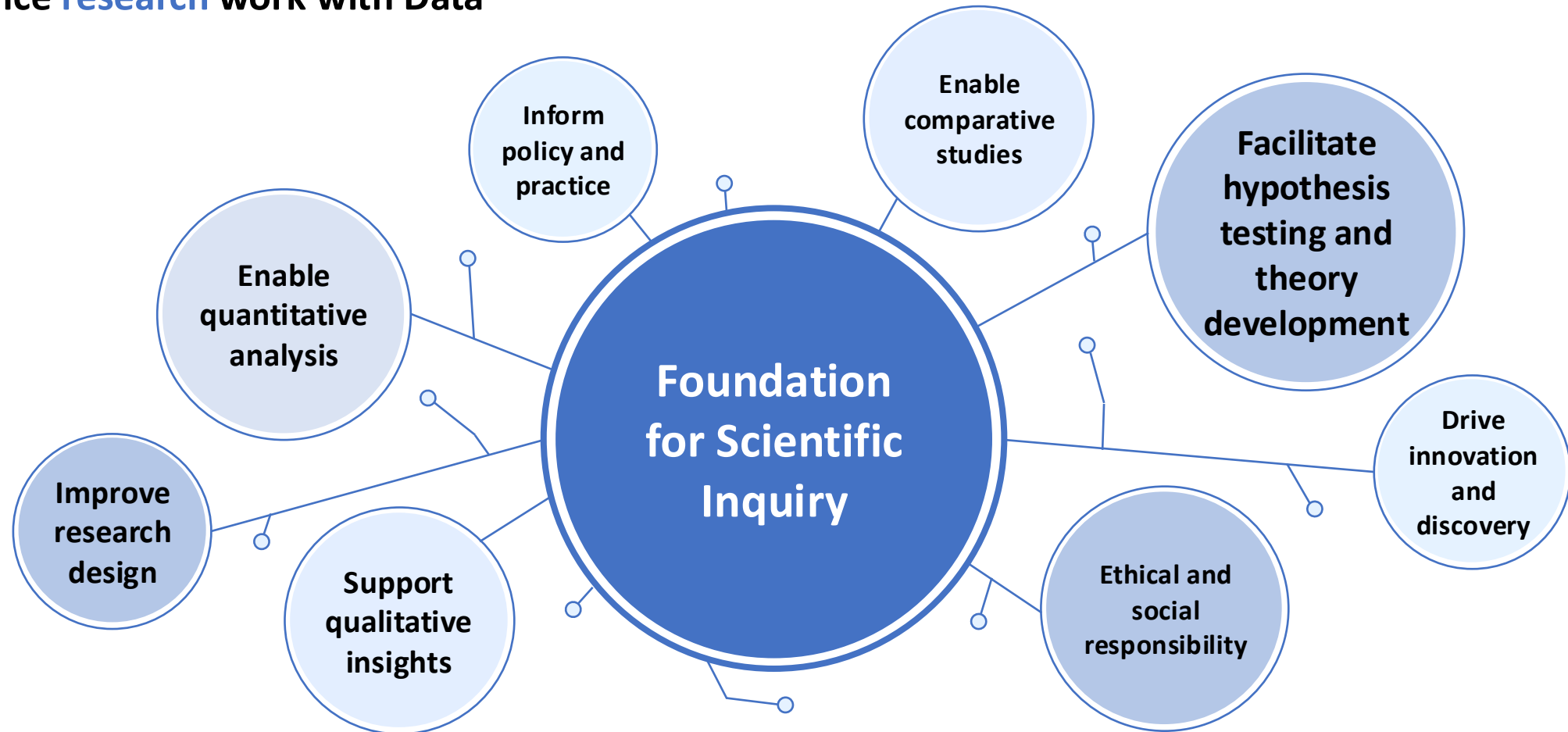
Importance of Data in Decision-Making

- Role of data in **modern business** decision-making



Importance of Data in Decision-Making (cont.)

- Enhance **research** work with Data



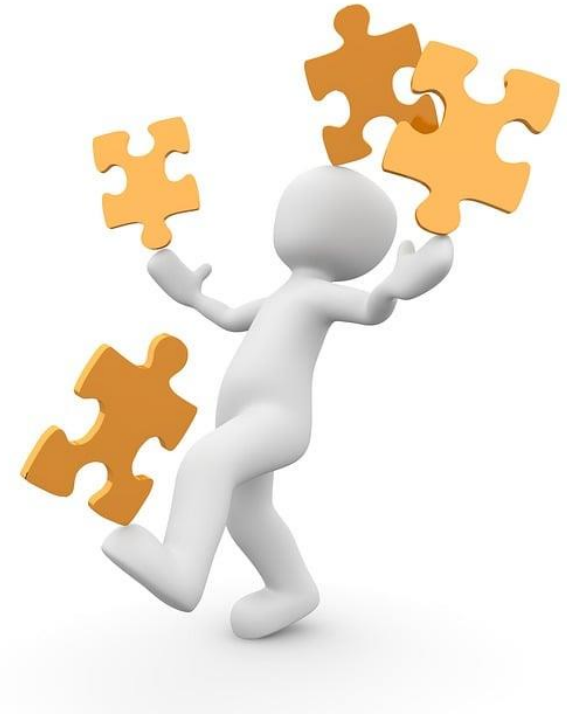
Data Discovery

- **Data discovery** is the process of **identifying** and **understanding data sources** that can be used for analytical purposes.
- The **primary purpose** of data discovery is to
 - Gain **actionable insights** into the available data,
 - Understand its **potential** for analysis,
 - Determine how it can be used to **support decision-making** and research **objectives**.



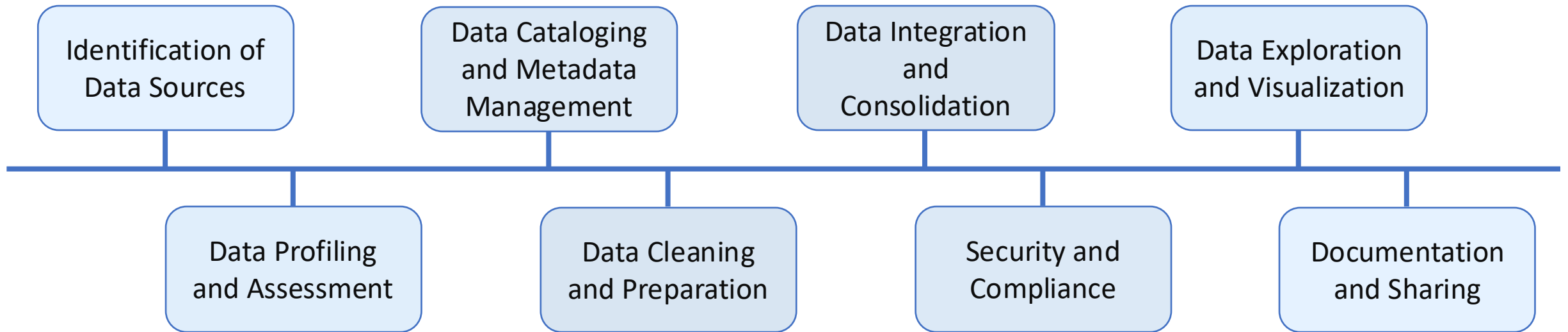
Challenges in Data Discovery

- Volume and complexity of data
- Data quality and silos
- Dynamic and evolving data
- Data privacy and security concerns
- Lack of metadata and documentation
- Interoperability and integration issues
- Resource constraints
- Finding actionable insights



Data Discovery Process

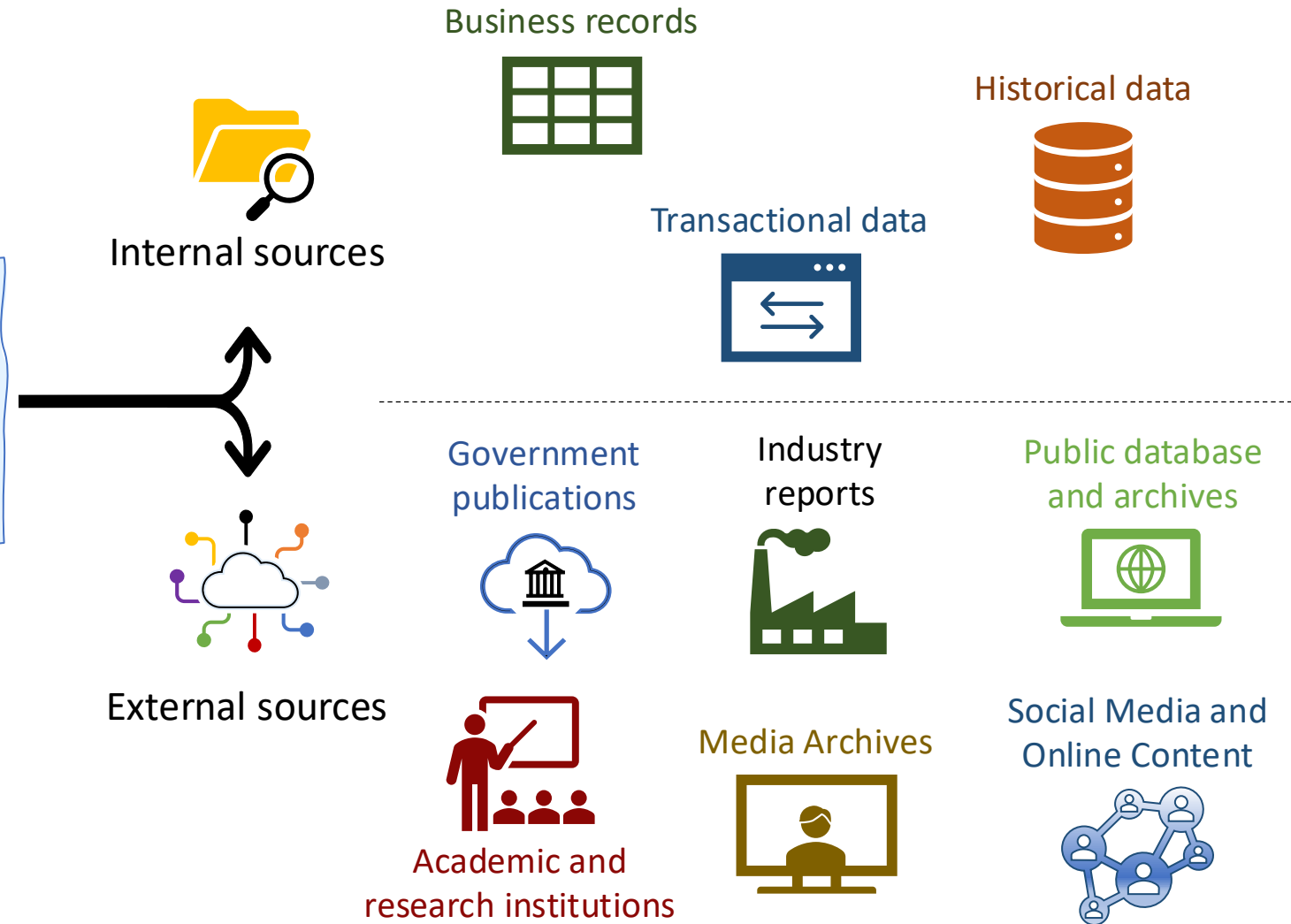
- Data discovery process involves a series of tasks aimed at **identifying**, **understanding**, and **preparing** data for analysis.



Data Discovery Process (cont.)

- Identification of Data Sources
 - Inventory Existing Data

Existing data, often referred to as *secondary data*, encompasses information that has already been collected for purposes **other than the specific research or analysis at hand**.



Data Discovery Process (cont.)

- Identification of Data Sources
 - Inventory Existing Data

Existing data, often referred to as *secondary data*, encompasses information that has already been collected for purposes *other than the specific research or analysis at hand*.

Advantages of Using Existing Data

- **Cost and time efficiency**
 - Collecting new data can be expensive and time-consuming. Utilizing existing data can significantly reduce both costs and time to insight.
- **Access to broad and diverse data**
 - Existing data can provide access to a wide range of information across different geographies, time periods, and populations.
- **Benchmarking and trends analysis**
 - Allows for the comparison of internal data against industry benchmarks or historical data, facilitating trend analysis and strategic planning.

Data Discovery Process (cont.)

- Identification of Data Sources
 - Inventory Existing Data

Existing data, often referred to as *secondary data*, encompasses information that has already been collected for purposes *other than the specific research or analysis at hand*.



Evaluate Data Relevance

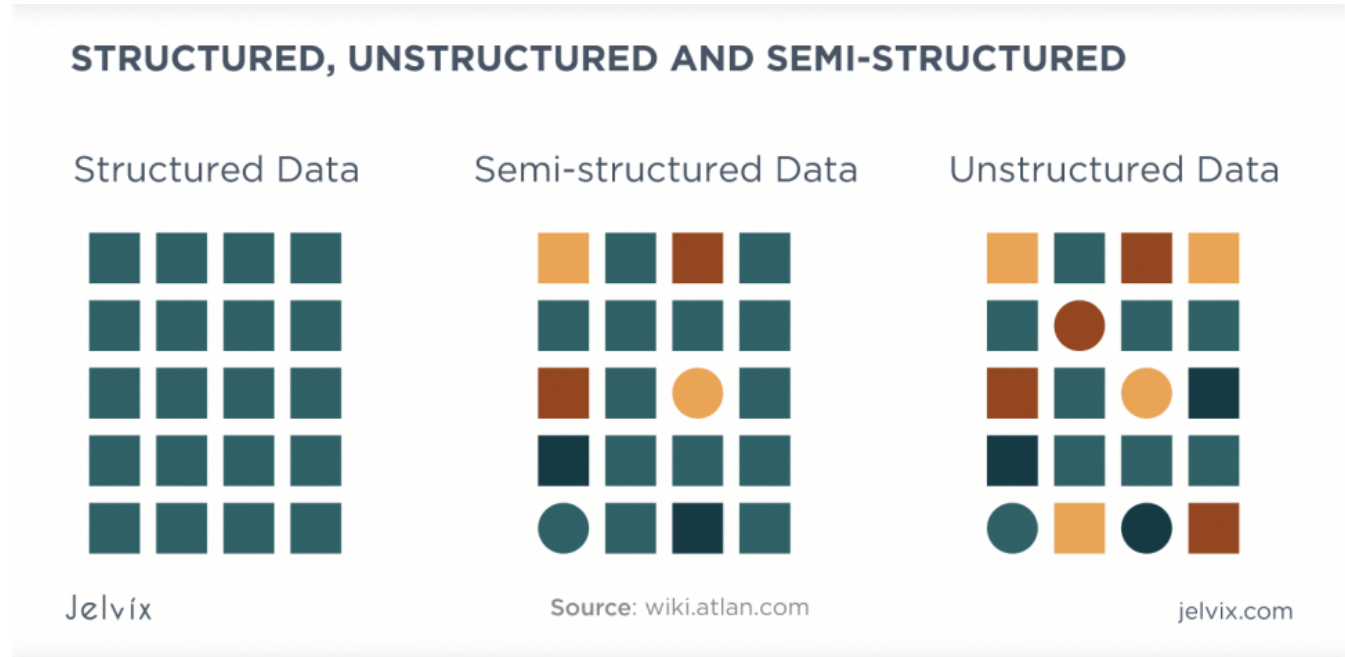
Assess the relevance of each data source to the business questions or analytical projects at hand.

Limitations of Using Existing Data

- **Relevance**
 - The data may not perfectly match the specific needs of the current analysis or research question.
- **Quality and accuracy**
 - The quality and accuracy of existing data can vary, and it may be outdated or not rigorously collected.
- **Accessibility**
 - Some data, especially from private sources or specific industries, may be difficult to access or require purchase.

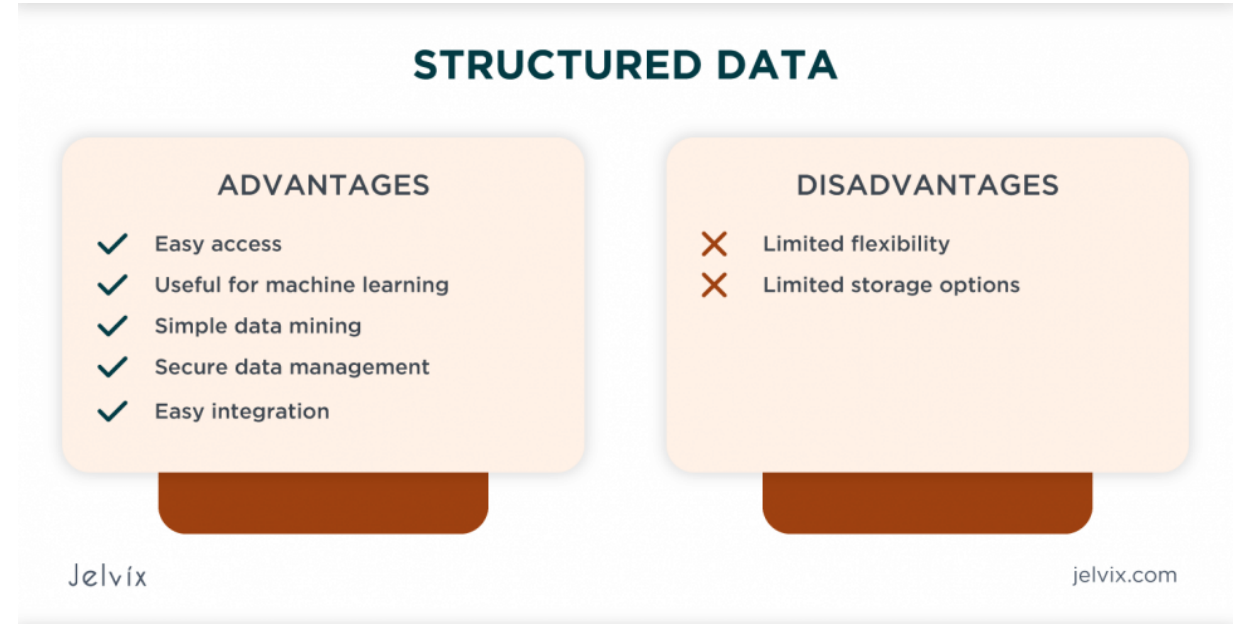
Data Discovery Process (cont.)

- **Data Profiling and Assessment**
 - Understand data structure
 - Content exploration
 - Quality assessment



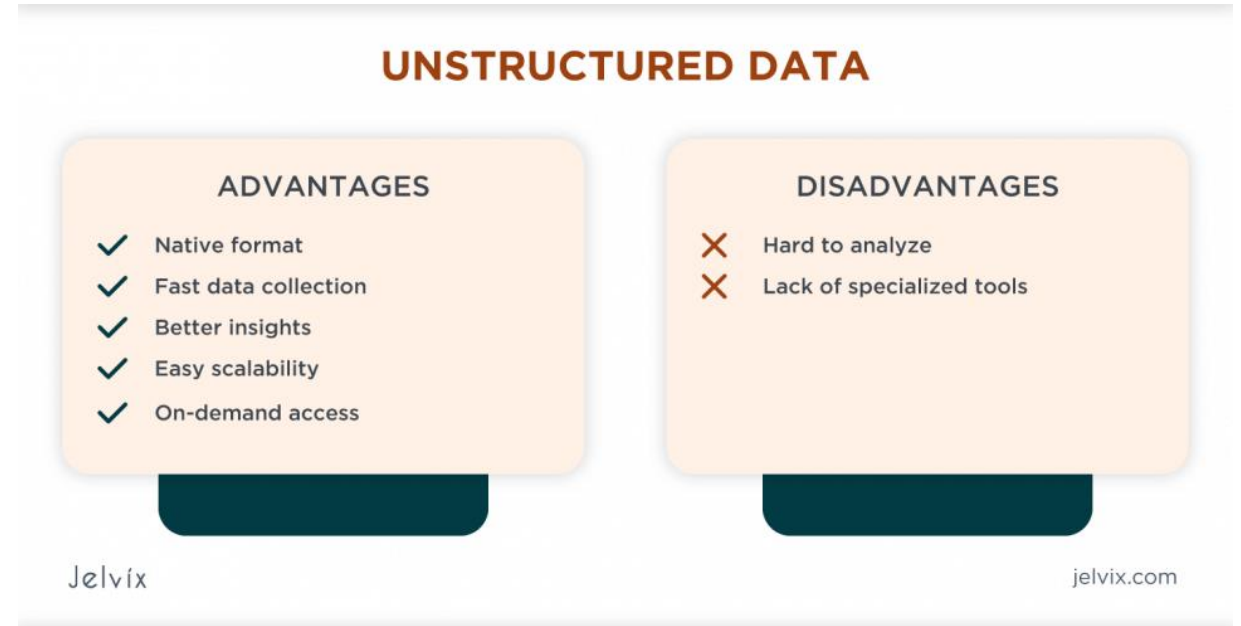
Data Discovery Process (cont.)

- Data Profiling and Assessment
 - Understand data structure
 - **Structured data** is highly organized and easily understandable by machine language, typically stored in databases.
 - Relational databases
 - Data warehouses



Data Discovery Process (cont.)

- Data Profiling and Assessment
 - Understand data structure
 - **Unstructured data** is information that doesn't have a pre-defined data model or is not organized in a pre-defined manner. It's more challenging to collect, process, and analyse.
 - Text data
 - Multimedia data



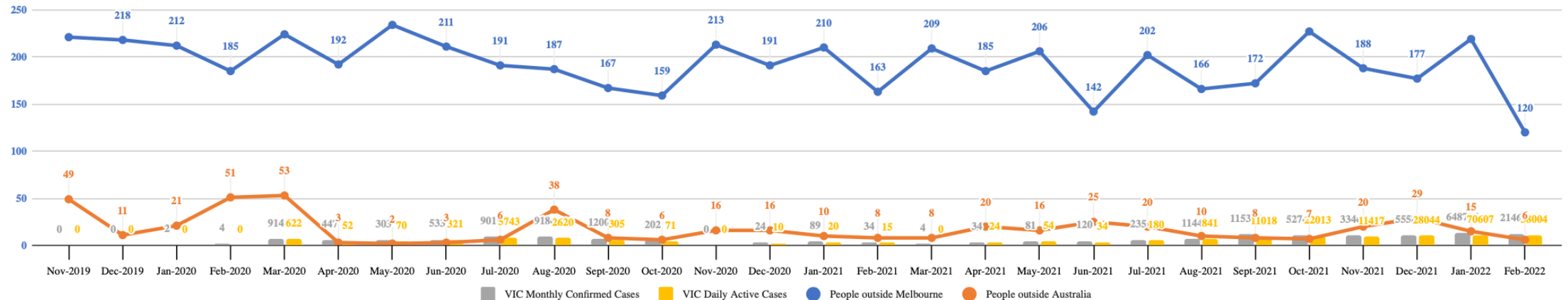
Data Discovery Process (cont.)

- Data Profiling and Assessment

- Understand data structure

- Time-series data

- Time-series data is data where sequences of values are indexed in time order, often in regular intervals.
 - This is common in financial analysis, sensor data, and application performance monitoring.



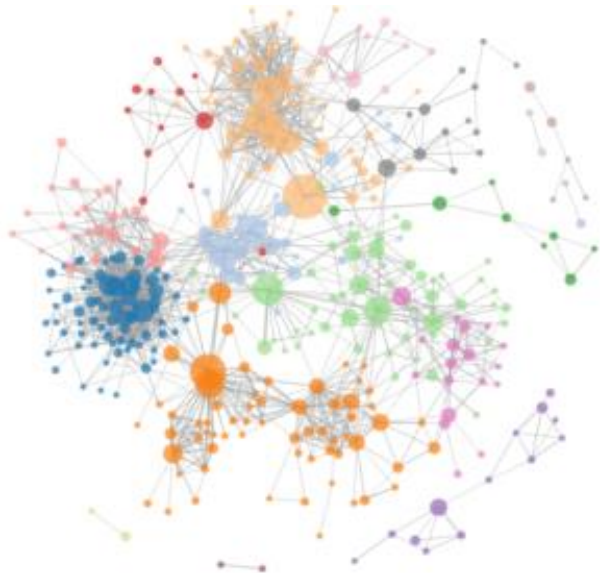
Data Discovery Process (cont.)

- **Data Profiling and Assessment**

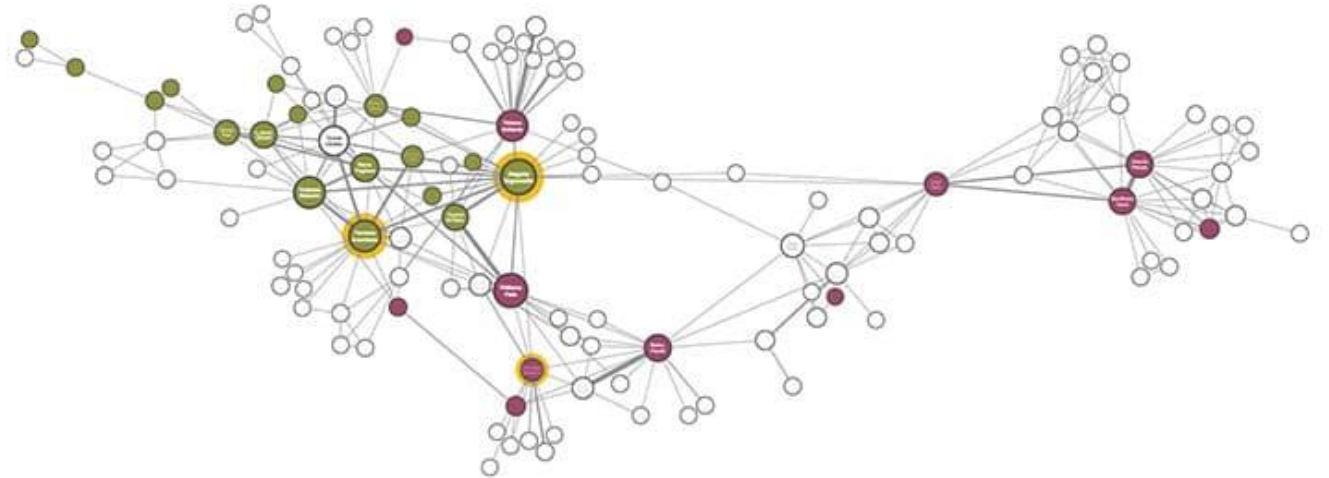
- Understand data structure

- **Graph data**

- Graph data models are used to represent relationships between entities in a flexible and intuitive way, making them ideal for social network analysis, recommendation systems, and fraud detection.



Source: Digital Humanities, Network Graph, University of Georgia,
<https://digi.uga.edu/network-graphs/>



Source: Cambridge Intelligence, what is graph visualization? <https://cambridge-intelligence.com/graph-visualization-software/>

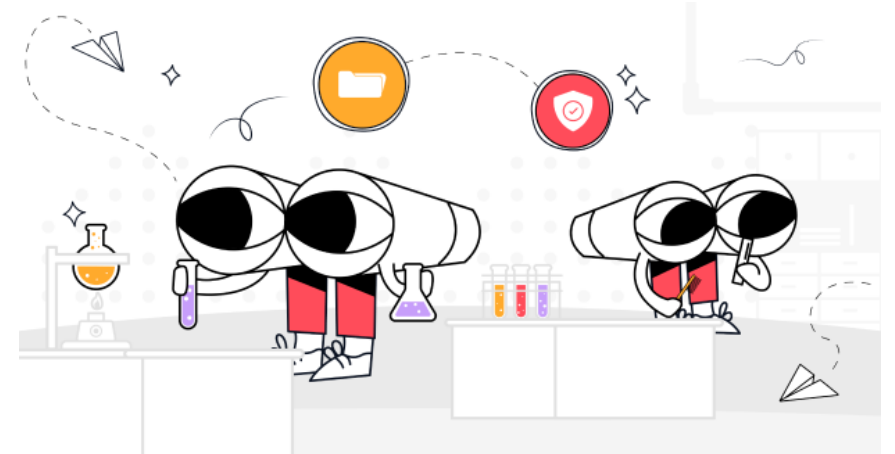
Data Discovery Process (cont.)

- Data Profiling and Assessment
 - Understand data structure
 - **Big data**
 - Refers to data that is so voluminous that traditional data processing software can't manage them.
 - Big data encompasses all the previously mentioned data structures but on a much larger scale and velocity.



Data Discovery Process (cont.)

- **Data Profiling and Assessment**
 - **Content Exploration**
 - Delve into the content of the data to understand the type of information it holds, such as categorical, numerical, or textual data.
 - **Quality Assessment**
 - Evaluate the quality of data by identifying issues such as missing values, duplicates, or inconsistencies.



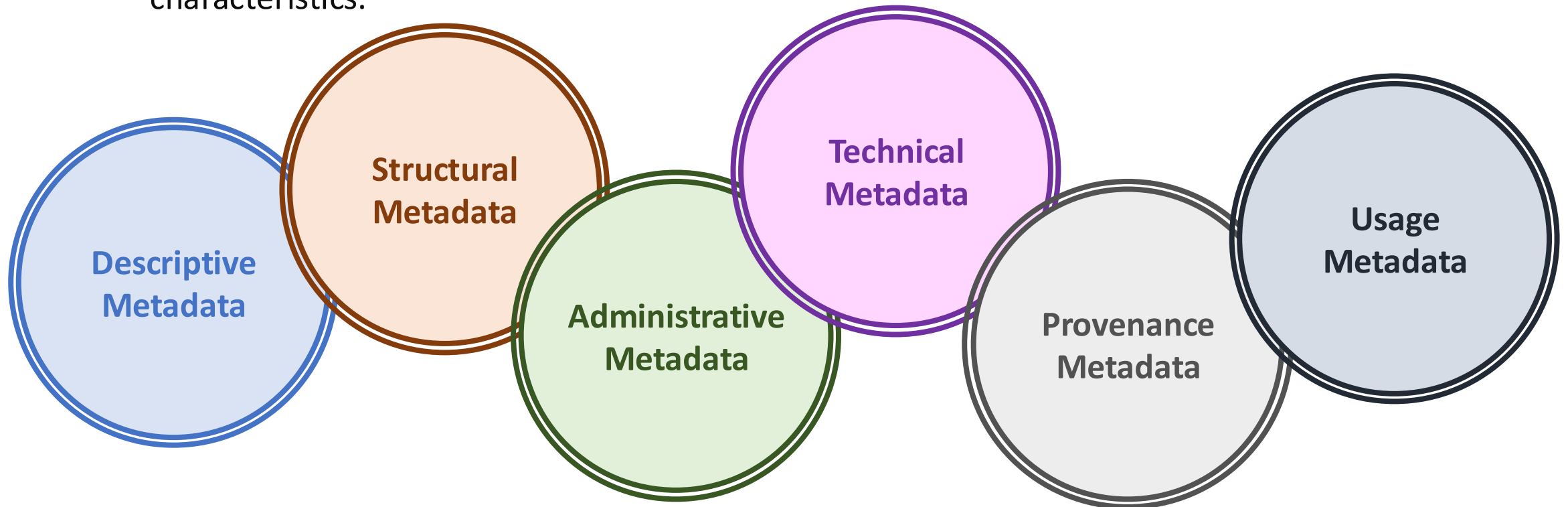
Source: Data Profiling: Definition, Types, Process, & More. <https://www.castordoc.com/blog/data-profiling-definition-types-process-more>

Data Discovery Process (cont.)

- **Data Cataloging and Metadata Management**

- **Metadata Collection**

- Gather metadata, which includes information about the data's origin, format, and characteristics.



Data Discovery Process (cont.)

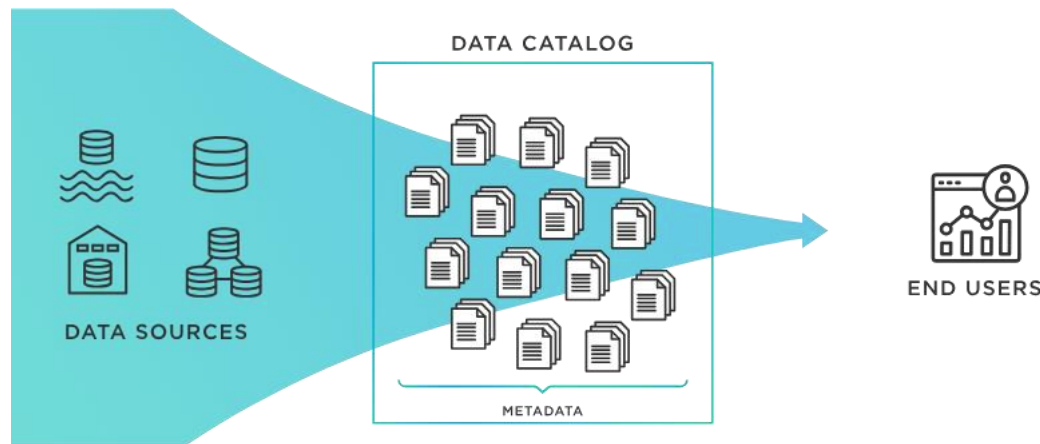
- **Data Cataloging and Metadata Management**

- **Catalog Creation**

- Create a searchable catalog of data assets, making it easier for users to find and understand the data they need.

- **Data Lineage Documentation**

- Document data lineage, tracing the data from its source through various transformations to its current state, to ensure transparency and trust in the data.



Source: <https://www.tibco.com/glossary/what-is-a-data-catalog>

Data Discovery Process (cont.)

- **Data Cleaning and Preparation**
 - **Data Cleansing**
 - Address data quality issues identified during profiling, such as correcting errors, filling missing values, or removing duplicates.
 - **Data Transformation**
 - Transform data into a format or structure that is suitable for analysis, which may include normalization, aggregation, or encoding of categorical variables.
- **Data Integration and Consolidation**
 - **Combine Data Sources**
 - Integrate data from multiple sources to create a comprehensive dataset that provides a unified view of the information.
 - **Ensure Consistency**
 - Harmonize data formats, units of measure, and other discrepancies across data sources to ensure consistency.

Data Discovery Process (cont.)

- **Security and Compliance Checks**

- **Data Privacy**

- Implement measures to protect sensitive information and personal data in compliance with privacy regulations (e.g., GDPR, HIPAA).

- **Access Control**

- Establish data access controls to ensure that only authorized users can access certain data, based on their roles and the data's sensitivity.

- **Data Exploration and Visualization**

- **Exploratory Data Analysis (EDA)**

- Conduct an initial exploration of the data to uncover patterns, trends, and anomalies using statistical summaries and visualization tools.

- **Visualization**

- Use data visualization techniques to represent data graphically, making it easier to identify relationships, outliers, and patterns.

Data Discovery Process (cont.)

- **Documentation and Sharing**
 - **Document Findings**
 - Document the findings from data exploration, including insights, challenges, and potential uses of the data.
 - **Share Insights**
 - Share the documented findings and data visualizations with stakeholders to facilitate data-driven decision-making.



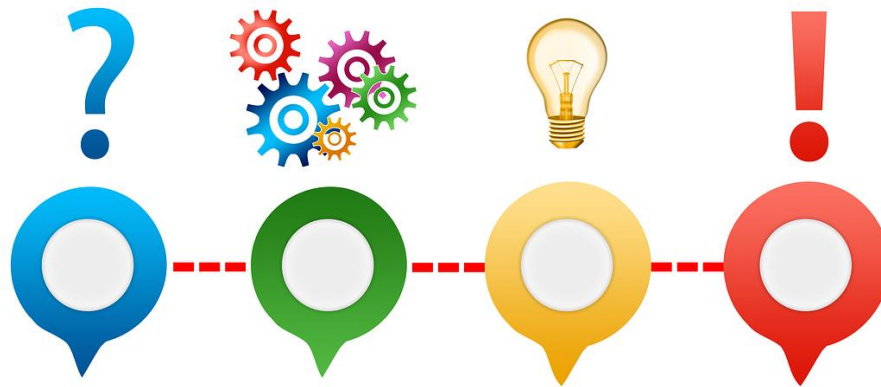
Data Discovery Tools & Platforms

- **Data discovery tools** are essential in today's data-driven world, helping organizations and researchers to [uncover insights](#), [trends](#), and [patterns](#) from vast amounts of data.



Outline

- What is Data Discovery?
- Data Discovery Process
- **What is Data Collection?**
- **Data Collection Methods**



Data Collection

- **Data collection** is the systematic process of **gathering** and **measuring** information on variables of interest, in an established systematic fashion that enables one to answer stated research questions, test hypotheses, and evaluate outcomes.
- The process can vary in methodology.
- Data collection is foundational to the empirical approach in various domains, facilitating a **deep understanding** of **complex issues**, **guiding strategic planning**, and **enabling the measurement of outcomes**.



Source: <https://www.pngegg.com/en/png-nxbqm>

Primary vs. Secondary Data

- **Primary Data**

- **Original data**, is collected **firsthand** by the researcher for a specific research purpose or project.
- Primary data is collected **directly from the source**, allowing the researcher to **control** the **quality, purpose, methodology**, and **scope** of the data.

- **Secondary Data**

- Information that was **collected** by someone else for **a different purpose** but is being used for a new project.
- Secondary data has **already** been **gathered, compiled**, and often **analysed** or **interpreted** before the current project.

Quantitative vs. Qualitative Data

- **Quantitative Data**

- Any data that **can be quantified** or **measured numerically**.
- It is data that can be expressed in **numbers** and involves measurable quantities.
- The **focus** is on the **quantity** of the data rather than its qualitative aspects.
- It is often used to **formulate facts** and **uncover patterns** in research.
- Often collected using structured research instruments like surveys and experiments.
- Suitable for statistical analysis to test hypotheses or predict outcomes.
- Can be displayed through graphs, charts, and tables for interpretation.

- **Qualitative Data**

- Qualitative data is **descriptive** and **conceptual**.
- It is data that can be **observed** but **not measured** with numbers.
- Often used to understand concepts, thoughts, or experiences and provides insights into the problem or helps to develop ideas or hypotheses for potential quantitative research.
- Describes qualities or characteristics.
- Data is usually textual or visual.
- Analysis can be more subjective and involves interpretation of meanings from the data.

Data Collection Methods – Structured Data

- For **structured data**
 - Surveys and questionnaires
 - Key considerations to ensure the reliability and validity of the data collected.
 - Clearly define objectives
 - Question design
 - Sampling
 - Pilot testing
 - Ethical considerations
 - Distribution method



Source: <https://www.pngegg.com/en/png-dberq>

Data Collection Methods – Structured Data

- For **structured data**

- Online forms

- User experience and design
 - Privacy and security
 - Accessibility
 - Data quality



Google Forms



- web scraping

- Legal and ethical considerations
 - Technical challenges
 - Data quality and relevance
 - Efficiency and resource utilisation

Web Scraping



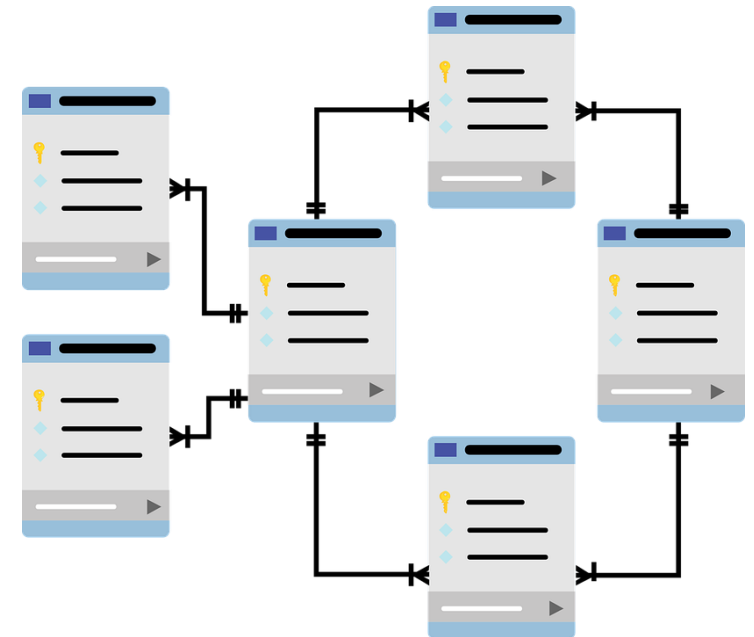
Beautiful Soup



Source: <https://www.pngegg.com/en/png-xdgxk>

Data Collection Methods – Structured Data

- For **structured data**
 - Relational databases
 - Database design and structure
 - Data quality and integrity
 - Scalability and performance
 - Security measures
 - Backup and recovery
 - Compliance with regulations
 - Data accessibility and documentation
 - Monitoring and maintenance



Source: <https://www.pngegg.com/en/png-tqpzo>

Data Collection Methods – Structured Data

- For **structured data**
 - API
 - API documentation review
 - Authentication and authorisation
 - Rate limiting and quotas
 - Data pagination
 - Error handling
 - Data efficiency and minimisation
 - Compliance with API terms of service
 - Data storage and management
 - Monitoring and maintenance



Source: <https://www.pngegg.com/en/png-iwevt>

Data Collection Methods – Unstructured Data

- For **unstructured data**
 - Text mining and natural language processing (NLP)
 - Data quality and volume
 - Data preparation and pre-processing
 - Choose the right NLP techniques and models
 - Understanding context and nuances
 - Ethical considerations and bias
 - Performance evaluation and validation
 - Scalability and computational resources
 - Integration with other data sources

Natural Language
Tool Kit (NLTK)
Basic Text Analytics



Natural Language Processing
(NLP) with Python and SpaCy
spaCy



Chat GPT



Source: <https://www.pngegg.com/en/png-zaepp>

Data Collection Methods – Unstructured Data

- For **unstructured data**
 - Image and video data collection
 - Consistent quality and high-resolution data
 - Diversity and representation
 - Ethical considerations and legal compliance
 - Large file sizes and data organisation
 - Accurate annotations and labelling
 - Conversion and processing for standard formats
 - Ethical use and bias mitigation
 - Bandwidth and transfer
 - Real-time processing



Source: <https://www.pngegg.com/en/png-ejtu>

Data Collection Methods – Unstructured Data

- For **unstructured data**
 - Social media and web content
 - Legal and ethical consideration
 - Adherence to APIs terms of use
 - Changes in API access
 - Dynamic content
 - Handling noise
 - Anonymisation and data processing
 - Sampling bias and cultural context
 - Long-term accessibility
 - Archiving and preservation



Data Collection Methods – Semi-structured Data

- For semi-structured data
 - JSON and XML data extraction
 - Understand data structure
 - Hierarchical structure
 - schema/schemaless
 - Parsing data using libraries
 - Regular expression
 - Character encoding
 - Handling inconsistencies and errors

JavaScript Object Notation (JSON):

```
1 {  
2   "meta" : {  
3     "view" : {  
4       "id" : "tdvh-n9dv",  
5       "name" : "Melbourne bike share",  
6       "attribution" : "City of Melbourne, Australia",  
7       "averageRating" : 0,  
8       "category" : "Transport & Movement",  
9       "createdAt" : 1428898164,  
10      "description" : "Melbourne Bike Share is a joint RACV/Victoria  
11      "displayType" : "table",  
12      "downloadCount" : 1314,  
13      "indexUpdatedAt" : 1453946128,  
14      "licenseId" : "CC_30_BY_AUS",  
15      "newBackend" : false,  
16      "numberOfComments" : 0,  
17      "oid" : 11003321,  
18      "publicationAppendEnabled" : true,  
19      "publicationDate" : 1429672791,  
20      "publicationGroup" : 2657856,
```

Extensible Markup Language (XML)

```
<response>  
  <row>  
    <row_id="155" _uuid="7C09387D-9E6C-4B42-9041-9A98B88F54"  
    <id>2</id>  
    <featurename>Harbour Town - Docklands Dve - Dockland  
    <terminalname>60000</terminalname>  
    <nbbikes>9</nbbikes>  
    <nemptydoc>14</nemptydoc>  
    <uploaddate>1453986006</uploaddate>  
    <coordinates human_address="{&quot;address&quot;:&qu  
      latitude="-37.814022" longitude="144.93  
    </row>  
    <row_id="156" _uuid="52739A59-E034-436B-A613-E7A5F62448"  
    <id>4</id>  
    <featurename>Federation Square - Flinders St / Swans  
    <terminalname>60001</terminalname>  
    <nbbikes>15</nbbikes>  
    <nemptydoc>7</nemptydoc>  
    <uploaddate>1453986006</uploaddate>  
    <coordinates human_address="{&quot;address&quot;:&qu  
      latitude="-37.817523" longitude="144.96
```

Data Collection Methods – Semi-structured Data

- For **semi-structured data**
 - Logs and sensor data collection
 - Volume and velocity
 - High throughput
 - Stream processing
 - Variability and structure
 - Diverse formats and standardisation
 - Time-sensitivity
 - Timestamps and time zone awareness
 - Interoperability
 - Automated alerts and actions



Source: <https://www.pngegg.com/en/png-mrtrd/download>

Data Collection Methods – Semi-structured Data

- For **semi-structured data**
 - Email and communication data collection
 - Privacy and Legal Compliance
 - Consent and Authorization
 - Sensitive Information
 - Data Structuring and Formatting
 - Complex Structures
 - Metadata Extraction
 - Handling Attachments
 - Data Quality and Integrity
 - De-duplication
 - Noise Filtering



Source: <https://www.pngegg.com/en/png-hvcvm>

Ethical Considerations and Privacy

- **Ethical considerations and privacy** are **paramount** in the data collection process, guiding how data should be collected, stored, used, and shared.
- These considerations protect individuals' rights and maintain trust between data collectors and subjects.

Informed Consent

- Transparency and openness
- Voluntariness
- Understanding

Compliance with Laws and Regulations

- Legal compliance
- Ethical standards

Respect for Participants

- Respect for autonomy
- Beneficence and non-maleficence
- Accountability

Data Retention and Disposal

- Retention policy
- Secure disposal

Privacy and Anonymity

- Protecting personal information
- anonymisation

Data Security

- Secure storage and transmission
- Access controls

Minimisation and Necessity

- Data minimisation
- Purpose limitation

Equity and Fairness

- Inclusive data collection
- Fair treatment

Ethical Considerations and Privacy

- **Ethical considerations and privacy** are **paramount** in the data collection process, guiding how data should be collected, stored, used, and shared.
- These considerations protect individuals' rights and maintain trust between data collectors and subjects.

Summary & To-do List

- Please download and read the materials provided on Moodle.
- Review the content learnt from Week 2.
- Assessment
 - Group selection open for Exercise Assessment
 - Same group work on the assessments across the semester
 - Be serious to form the group and no changes can be made after Week 4
- Next week: Exploratory Data Analysis (EDA)